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COSY*languages*

ENGLISH GRAMMAR MANUAL

The complete reference for beginner learners

LEVEL A0 – A1

English Grammar Manual — Level A0–A1

First Edition · 2026

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FOUNDER & LEAD TEACHER

Damir Moskov is the founder and lead teacher at COSYlanguages, where this manual was written, tested in real lessons, and refined for learners who want to genuinely understand English grammar — not just memorise it.

ABOUT COSYLANGUAGES

COSYlanguages is an English-learning project built around clear, structured, teacher-guided materials for adult and teen learners. Every level is designed to be worked through with a teacher's support, in individual lessons, group courses, or structured self-study challenges.

THE COMPLETE LEARNING SYSTEM

Every level at COSYlanguages — from A0–A1 through to advanced levels — is built around four companion manuals that work together: **Grammar** (this book), **Vocabulary**, **Speaking**, **Exercises**.

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Every grammar point taught at COSYlanguages, from first words to first conversations. The small icons show which visual tool each page uses.

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How This Manual Works

A few visual signs that will help you understand the grammar — not just memorise it.

COLOUR CODE USED IN EXAMPLES

Subject

who or what does the action — *She reads.*

Noun / object

a person, place or thing — *She reads a book.*

Question word

asks for information — *Where is it?*

Verb / action

the action itself — *She reads.*

Adjective

describes a noun — *a good book.*

Ending that changes

the letters added to a word — *works.*

VISUAL THINKING TOOLS — FOR DIFFERENT WAYS OF LEARNING

Everyone learns differently — some people think in pictures, some in timing, some by building things step by step. This manual mixes all three on purpose.

Timeline

shows when something happens — past, now, or future.

Building blocks

shows how a sentence is built, piece by piece, like snapping blocks together.

Intensity scale

shows how strong, frequent, or far along the gradient sits.

Decision tree

helps you pick the right rule by following a simple question down to the answer.

Picture diagram

a small illustration that shows a rule visually instead of in words.

Flashcards

irregular or exception words shown as quick-reference cards.

ICONS USED IN THIS MANUAL

Common mistakes

real errors beginners make, and the correct form next to them.

Right

a correct sentence — the form to use.

Memory trick

a mnemonic, rhyme, or association to help the rule stick.

Notice

a guiding question to help you spot the pattern yourself.

Wrong

a mistake to avoid — shown crossed out.

REGIONAL VARIANT BADGES

 British English (also close to Australian & New Zealand English)  American English  Canadian English (a mix of British & American)  Australian English

These badges appear wherever grammar genuinely differs between English-speaking countries — see the Appendix for a full reference.

EXAMPLE OF A FULLY CODED SENTENCE

She **reads** a **book**.

Subject + verb (+ ending, because it's she) + noun.

Basic Word Order

Subject + Verb + Object



Vocabulary theme for practice: Family

Rule: a basic English sentence follows the order **Subject** → **Verb** → **Object**. The subject does the action; the verb is the action; the object receives the action. This order does not usually change.



SUBJECT	VERB	OBJECT
I	like	pizza.
She	reads	books.
They	play	football.
He	drinks	tea.

More examples

- **I study** English.
- **My brother drives** a car.
- **We love** music.
- **The children eat** breakfast.

⚠ COMMON MISTAKES



~~Pizza I like.~~



I like pizza.



~~Books reads she.~~



She reads books.



~~Football play they.~~



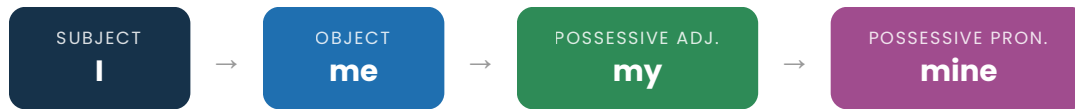
They play football.

Pronouns

Subject, object, possessive adjective & possessive pronoun



Vocabulary theme for practice: People you know



SUBJECT	OBJECT	POSSESSIVE ADJ.	POSSESSIVE PRON.	EXAMPLE
I	me	my	mine	This book is mine .
you	you	your	yours	Is this pen yours ?
he	him	his	his	That phone is his .
she	her	her	hers	This bag is hers .
it	it	its	—	The dog wags its tail.
we	us	our	ours	This house is ours .
they	them	their	theirs	Those keys are theirs .

QUESTION WORD	ASKS ABOUT	EXAMPLE
Who	the subject (who does it?)	Who likes pizza? — I do.
Whose	the owner (possession)	Whose is this bag? — It's mine.

⚠ COMMON MISTAKES



~~Me am happy.~~



I am happy.



~~This is she book.~~



This is her book.



~~This bag is her.~~



This bag is hers.

The Verb 'To Be'

Am, is, are — affirmative, negative & question



Vocabulary theme for practice: Jobs & nationalities



I'm

SUBJECT	AFFIRMATIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION
I	I am (I'm)	I am not (I'm not)	Am I...?
You / We / They	You are (You're)	You are not (aren't)	Are you...?
He / She / It	He is (He's)	He is not (isn't)	Is he...?

Use: names, nationality, age, feelings, jobs and facts. *She **is** French. He **is** 25. We **are** happy. They **are** doctors.*

⚠ COMMON MISTAKES



~~I is a student.~~



I **am** a student.



~~She are happy.~~



She **is** happy.



~~They is late.~~



They **are** late.



~~I don't am hungry.~~



I **am not** hungry.

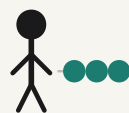
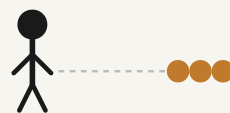
More examples

- I'm a student.
- We **are** from France.
- You **are** very kind.
- It **is** cold today.
- My parents **are** teachers.
- **Is** it Monday today?

This, That, These, Those

Demonstratives — talking about distance

 Vocabulary theme for practice: Everyday objects

			
THIS (near, 1)	THAT (far, 1)	THESE (near, many)	THOSE (far, many)

	NEAR	FAR
SINGULAR	THIS — This is my dog.	THAT — That is your house, over there.
PLURAL	THESE — These are new students.	THOSE — Those are old photos.

Rule: use *this/that* before a singular noun and *these/those* before a plural noun. *This book* / *These books*.
This vs. it: use *this* to introduce something new (*This is my brother.*); once it's known, use *it* (*It's very tall.*).

 **CONNECTS TO WHAT YOU ALREADY KNOW**

Plural Nouns (page 10) — these/those always pair with a plural noun — you'll meet the plural rules two pages ahead.

COMMON MISTAKES

-  ~~This are my shoes.~~
-  **These are my shoes.**
-  ~~Those is my brother.~~
-  **That is my brother.**
-  ~~I like this books.~~
-  **I like these books.**

Articles: A / An / The

Choosing the right article



Vocabulary theme for practice: Animals

EXAMPLE		
consonant sound	A	I have a dog and a cat.
vowel sound	AN	She has an apple and an egg.
specific thing	THE	The sun is hot. Close the door, please.
general / plural	— (no article)	I like cats. Children love music.



LISTEN, DON'T JUST LOOK

Say the next word. Vowel sound (a, e, i, o, u)? Use *an*: an apple, an hour. Any other sound? Use *a*: a dog, a university (starts with a 'y' sound, not a vowel sound).



DEFINITE (THE) VS. INDEFINITE (A/AN)

One specific thing that both people already know? Use *the*: Close the door (= our one door). Any one, or a new thing you haven't mentioned before? Use *a/an*: I saw a dog (= just one dog, not a special one).



MEMORY TRICK

The extra N in *an* exists just to stop two vowel sounds crashing into each other. Say "a apple" out loud — it's awkward! The n smooths the join: "an apple."

COMMON MISTAKES



~~I have an dog.~~



I have **a** dog.



~~She is a engineer.~~



She is **an** engineer.



~~I like the music in general.~~



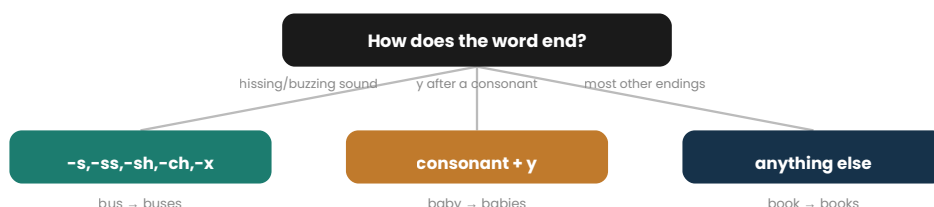
I like **music**.

Plural Nouns

Regular and irregular forms



Vocabulary theme for practice: Animals & objects



RULE	SINGULAR → PLURAL
Most nouns: + s	book → books, cat → cats
-s, -ss, -sh, -ch, -x: + es	bus → buses, box → boxes
consonant + y: y → ies	baby → babies, city → cities
vowel + y: + s	day → days, toy → toys
some -f / -fe: → ves	leaf → leaves, knife → knives



WHY -S ISN'T ALWAYS ENOUGH

Does the word end in -s, -x, -ch or -sh? Add -es: box → boxes. Does it end in consonant + y? Change y to -ies: baby → babies.

Irregular plurals — learn by heart

man
→ **men**

woman
→ **women**

child
→ **children**

person
→ **people**

foot
→ **feet**

tooth
→ **teeth**



MEMORY TRICK

Foot → feet, tooth → teeth — say them together and hear it: the double OO sound stretches into a double EE sound.

COMMON MISTAKES



~~I have two childs.~~



I have two children.



~~Many mans are here.~~



Many men are here.



~~I have three foots.~~



I have three feet.

There is/are & There was/were

Talking about what exists, now, before & in the future

 Vocabulary theme for practice: The classroom

Timeline — there is/are moves through time just like to be



TENSE	AFFIRMATIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION
Present, one	There is a cat in the garden.	There isn't a cat in the garden.	Is there a cat in the garden?
Present, many	There are two cats in the garden.	There aren't two cats in the garden.	Are there two cats in the garden?
Past, one	There was a cat in the garden.	There wasn't a cat in the garden.	Was there a cat in the garden?
Past, many	There were two cats in the garden.	There weren't two cats in the garden.	Were there two cats in the garden?
Future	There will be a party.	There won't be a party.	Will there be a party?

There vs. it: use *there* to say something exists (*There is a shop nearby.*); use *it* to describe something already mentioned, or weather/time (*It is a big shop. It's raining. It's 5 o'clock.*).

 CONNECTS TO WHAT YOU ALREADY KNOW

The Verb 'To Be' (page 7) — is/are/was/were are the same verb to be forms, doing a new job.

⚠ COMMON MISTAKES

-  ~~It has a cat in the garden.~~
-  **There is a cat in the garden.**
-  ~~There is two dogs.~~
-  **There are two dogs.**
-  ~~There was many people at the party.~~
-  **There were many people at the party.**

More examples

- **There is** a park near my house.
- **There was** a party at my house last week.
- **There will be** a test tomorrow.

Whose...? Possessive 's

Showing who owns what



Vocabulary theme for practice: Family & belongings



EXAMPLE		
one owner	's	This is Mike's car.
plural owners	s'	The girls' bags are on the table.
question	Whose...?	Whose bag is this? It's Anna's .



THE OWNER COMES FIRST

Find the owner, then add 's right after it: *Mike's car*. No word for 'of' is needed. Owner already ends in -s (like parents)? Just add the apostrophe: *parents' house*.

Rule: add 's after a singular owner (*the dog's toy*) and just ' after a plural noun ending in -s (*my parents' house*). Use *whose* to ask about ownership.



CONNECTS TO WHAT YOU ALREADY KNOW

Pronouns (page 6) — you already met my/your/his/her — 's does the same job as those possessive adjectives, just for names and nouns.

COMMON MISTAKES



~~This is Mike book.~~



This is Mike's book.



~~This is car of my father.~~



This is my father's car.

More examples

- **My father's** car is blue.
- The **children's** toys are on the floor.

Present Simple

Routines, habits & facts



Vocabulary theme for practice: Daily routines

SUBJECT	AFFIRMATIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION
I / You / We / They	I work	I don't work	Do you work?
He / She / It	She works	She doesn't work	Does she work?



WHY DOES THE VERB CHANGE?

Is the subject he, she, it, or a name (like Tom)? Add -s to the verb. Any other subject (I, you, we, they)? No change at all.



MEMORY TRICK

He, She, It — one person needs one extra letter: -S. Think of it as the verb wearing a name tag for a single, specific person.

Timeline — a habit repeats across past, present & future



Spelling of he/she/it: most verbs add -s (*like* → *likes*); after -ch, -sh, -ss, -x, -o add -es (*watch* → *watches*, *go* → *goes*); consonant+y → -ies (*study* → *studies*); have → has.

More examples

- I **get up** at seven every day.
- She **works** in a school.
- **Do** you speak English?

COMMON MISTAKES

- ☒ ~~She work every day.~~
- ☒ **She works every day.**
- ☒ ~~He don't like tea.~~
- ☒ **He doesn't like tea.**
- ☒ ~~Do she like pizza?~~
- ☒ **Does she like pizza?**

Present Continuous

Actions happening now



Vocabulary theme for practice: Actions right now

SUBJECT	AFFIRMATIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION
I	I am working	I am not working	Am I working?
He / She / It	He is working	He isn't working	Is he working?
You / We / They	We are working	We aren't working	Are we working?



TWO PARTS, ONE JOB EACH

Two parts: am/is/are (matches the subject) + verb -ing (always the same). Forget the -ing, and it's not 'happening now' anymore.

Timeline — one action, happening exactly now



Spelling of -ing: drop silent -e (*make* → *making*); double the last consonant after one vowel (*run* → *running*); -ie → y (*lie* → *lying*).



CONNECTS TO WHAT YOU ALREADY KNOW

The Verb 'To Be' (page 7) — am/is/are here are the exact forms from page 7 — now paired with -ing to talk about right now.

More examples

- I'm **reading** a book now.
- She's **cooking** dinner at the moment.
- Is it raining?

COMMON MISTAKES



~~I am reading a book every day.~~



I **read** a book every day. (habit = present simple)



~~She is cook now.~~



She **is cooking** now.



~~He working now.~~



He **is working** now.

Present Simple vs Continuous

Choosing the right tense



Vocabulary theme for practice: Free time

Present Simple

- Routines and habits
- Facts and general truths
- Permanent situations

She **drinks** tea every morning.

Present Continuous

- Actions happening right now
- Temporary situations
- Changing or new habits

She **is drinking** tea right now.

Timeline



More examples

- I usually **walk** to school, but today I'm **taking** the bus.
- He **plays** football every Saturday. Right now he's **playing** basketball.

⚠ COMMON MISTAKES



~~I am liking this song.~~



I like this song. (like = present simple, not continuous)



~~She usually is walking to work.~~



She usually walks to work.

Have Got

Talking about possession



Vocabulary theme for practice: Physical appearance

SUBJECT	AFFIRMATIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION
I / You / We / They	I've got a bike.	I haven't got a car.	Have you got a bike?
He / She / It	She's got a sister.	She hasn't got a brother.	Has she got a sister?

Timeline — possession is a state that continues



AROUND THE ENGLISH-SPEAKING WORLD

- UK** *Have got* is the everyday form for possession: *I've got a bike.*
 - US CA** Both *have got* and plain *have* are used and understood: *I've got a bike = I have a bike.*
 - AU** Follows British usage — *have got* is very common.
- Everywhere: for the past, use *had* only — *have got* has no separate past form.

More examples

- We've got a big house.
- Has he got blue eyes?
- They haven't got any children.
- I've got two brothers.

COMMON MISTAKES

- ✗ She has got a car? (wrong word order)
- ✓ Has she got a car?
- ✗ I have got not a car.
- ✓ I haven't got a car.

Can / Can't

Ability, permission & possibility



Vocabulary theme for practice: Hobbies & skills

AFFIRMATIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION
I/You/He/She/We/They can swim.	I/You/He/She/We/They can't swim.	Can you swim?

Timeline — ability/possibility holds across time



Three uses of can

ability	I can swim, but I can't ski.
permission	Can I open the window, please?
possibility	It can be very cold here in winter.

⚠ COMMON MISTAKES



~~She can to swim.~~



She can swim. (no 'to' after can)



~~He cans swim.~~



He can swim. (no -s after can)



~~I can not swim good.~~



I can't swim well.

More examples

- She **can** speak three languages.
- **Can** you help me, please?
- We **can't** come to the party.
- **Can** I use your phone?

Could / Couldn't

Past ability & polite requests



Vocabulary theme for practice: Childhood memories

AFFIRMATIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION
I/You/He/She/We/They could swim.	I/You/He/She/We/They couldn't swim.	Could you swim?

Timeline — a past ability, no longer the focus now



Two uses of could

past ability	I could swim when I was five, but I can't ski.
polite request	Could I have some water, please? / Could you help me?



COULD IS MORE POLITE THAN CAN

Can you help me? is fine between friends. *Could you help me?* sounds a little more polite — good for shops, strangers, or your teacher.



CONNECTS TO WHAT YOU ALREADY KNOW

Can / Can't (page 17) — could is simply can moved into the past — same meaning, further back in time.

COMMON MISTAKES



~~She could swimmmed when she was young.~~



She could swim when she was young.



~~Could you to help me?~~



Could you help me? (no 'to' after could)



~~I couldn't to come yesterday.~~



I couldn't come yesterday.

More examples

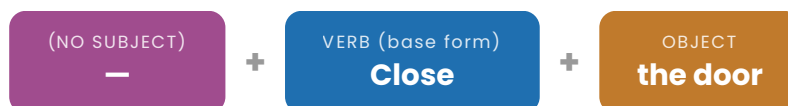
- I **could read** when I was four.
- He **couldn't come** to the party last week.
- **Could** you pass the salt, please?
- **Could** I ask you a question?

Imperatives

Instructions, rules & directions



Vocabulary theme for practice: Classroom instructions



instruction	Open the door, please.
rule / warning	Don't run in the classroom.
direction	Turn left and go straight on.
recipe / order	Add two eggs and mix well.

Form: base verb (no subject) for instructions, directions, rules and recipes. Add *don't* for the negative. *Sit down. Don't touch that. Please wait here.*

⚠ COMMON MISTAKES



~~You close the door.~~



Close the door, please. (no subject in imperatives)



~~Not touch that.~~



Don't touch that.

More examples

- **Close** the window, please.
- **Don't be** late for class.
- **Listen** carefully.
- **Wash** your hands before dinner.

I'd Like / Would You Like...?

Polite requests & offers



Vocabulary theme for practice: Café & restaurant



I'd

FUNCTION	EXAMPLE
Polite request	I'd like a coffee, please. (= I want, but more polite)
Offer	Would you like some tea?
Positive answer	Yes, please. I'd love some.
Negative answer	No, thank you. I'm fine.

*I'd = I would. Use *I'd like* (not *I want*) to sound polite in shops, cafés and restaurants.*

⚠ COMMON MISTAKES



~~I like a coffee, please.~~



I'd like a coffee, please.



~~Do you like some tea? (as an offer)~~



Would you like some tea?

More examples

- **I'd like** a sandwich, please.
- **Would** you like to come to my house?
- **I'd like** two tickets, please.
- **Would** you like some water?

Past Simple of 'To Be'

Was & were



Vocabulary theme for practice: Yesterday

SUBJECT	AFFIRMATIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION
I / He / She / It	I was at home.	I wasn't at work.	Was I late?
You / We / They	We were at home.	We weren't at work.	Were you late?

Timeline



More examples

- **Where were** you yesterday?
- It **wasn't** sunny this morning.



CONNECTS TO WHAT YOU ALREADY KNOW

The Verb 'To Be' (page 7) — was/were are just am/is/are moved into the past — same verb, one step back in time.

⚠ COMMON MISTAKES



~~I were at home.~~



I **was** at home.



~~They was late.~~



They **were** late.



~~She weren't ready.~~



She **wasn't** ready.

Past Simple: Regular Verbs

Spelling rules for the -ed ending



Vocabulary theme for practice: Last weekend

RULE	EXAMPLE
most verbs: + ed	work → worked, play → played
ends in -e: + d	live → lived, like → liked
consonant + y: y → ied	study → studied, cry → cried
1 vowel + consonant: double	stop → stopped, plan → planned

Timeline



MEMORY TRICK

STOP is short — one vowel, one final consonant. Picture the last letter looking in a mirror and doubling itself before -ed jumps on: stop → stopped.



LEARNT OR LEARNED?

Some regular verbs have two accepted past forms: **UK AU CA** learnt, dreamt, burnt vs. **US** learned, dreamed, burned. Both are understood everywhere.

COMMON MISTAKES



~~She studied every day.~~



She studied every day.



~~I stoped the car.~~



I stopped the car.

More examples

- She **studied** English for two years.
- We **stopped** at the traffic light.



CONNECTS TO WHAT YOU ALREADY KNOW

Present Simple (page 13) — same family of tense as page 13 — just describing habits and facts that are now finished.

Past Simple: Irregular Verbs

Verbs that don't follow the -ed rule



Vocabulary theme for practice: A trip



REGULAR VS. IRREGULAR

Regular verbs: add -ed. But common verbs like *go*, *have*, *see* are irregular — they change completely, with no -ed. Learn them one by one.

Timeline



Structure with irregular & regular verbs

AFFIRMATIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION
She worked / She went home.	She didn't work / didn't go home.	Did she work / go home?



MEMORY TRICK

Did is the magic word: once you use it, the main verb always goes back to its plain base form — even irregular ones. *Did she go?* never *Did she went?*

Common irregular verbs (*go* → *went*, *have* → *had*, *see* → *saw*...) don't follow the -ed rule at all — see the full grouped list in the Appendix at the end of this manual.

△ COMMON MISTAKES



~~+goed to school.~~



I went to school.



~~She didn't went home.~~



She didn't go home.



~~Did you saw him?~~



Did you see him?

More examples

- I **saw** her yesterday.
- We **had** a great time at the party.

Going To

Plans, intentions & predictions

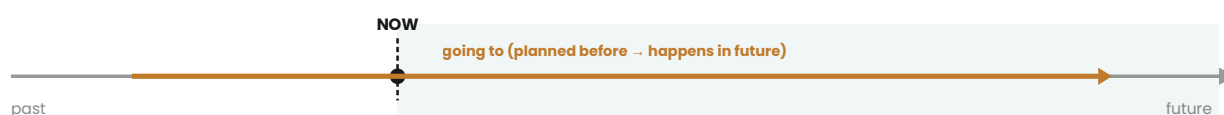


Vocabulary theme for practice: Holiday plans

SUBJECT	AFFIRMATIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION
I	I am going to travel.	I am not going to travel.	Am I going to travel?
He / She / It	He is going to travel.	He isn't going to travel.	Is he going to travel?
You / We / They	We are going to travel.	We aren't going to travel.	Are we going to travel?

Use: plans, intentions and predictions based on present evidence. *Look at those clouds — it's going to rain.*

Timeline — future in focus



⚠ COMMON MISTAKES

- ❌ ~~+go to visit my friend tomorrow.~~
- ✅ **I'm going to visit my friend tomorrow.**
- ❌ ~~-She is going travel.~~
- ✅ **She is going to travel.**

More examples

- I'm **going to** visit my grandmother this weekend.
- They're **going to** buy a new car.
- **Is** she going to study tonight?
- We're **not going to** watch TV today.



CONNECTS TO WHAT YOU ALREADY KNOW

Present Continuous (page 14) — going to uses the exact same am/is/are + -ing pattern you already know — just add 'going to' after it.

Will

Future predictions, promises & offers



Vocabulary theme for practice: Predictions about the future



A FIRST LOOK — FULLY PRACTISED AT A2

Will is included here so you can make simple offers and promises (*I'll help you*) — but most exam frameworks treat *will* as full A2 content. Don't worry if it still feels new; *going to* is the one to master solidly first.

AFFIRMATIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION
I will help you. (I'll)	I will not help you. (won't)	Will you help me?

Use: quick decisions, promises, offers and predictions without evidence. *I'll answer the phone. I think it will be sunny tomorrow.*



SHALL WE...?



Shall I...? / Shall we...? is common for offers and suggestions: *Shall we go?*



Shall is rare — people prefer *Should I...? Do you want to...? or How about...?*



Will vs Going To — future-focused timeline



COMMON MISTAKES



~~I will to help you.~~



I will help you.



~~She wills come tomorrow.~~



She will come tomorrow.

More examples

- **I'll help** you with your homework.
- **Will** you marry me?

Like / Love / Hate + -ing

Talking about preferences



Vocabulary theme for practice: Free-time activities



strong like — LOVE	I love dancing on Friday nights.
like — LIKE	She likes reading before bed.
no preference — DON'T MIND	He doesn't mind waiting a little.
strong dislike — HATE	They hate cleaning the kitchen.

Rule: after *like, love, hate, don't mind, enjoy*, the next verb takes the **-ing** form. *I like swimming.*

⚠ COMMON MISTAKES

- ❌ ~~I like to swimming.~~
- ✅ I like swimming.
- ❌ ~~She loves to dance and to sing.~~
- ✅ She loves dancing and singing.

More examples

- I **love watching** football.
- She **likes cooking** for her family.
- We **hate waiting** in long queues.
- Do you **enjoy travelling**?

Adjectives

Describing people & things

 Vocabulary theme for practice: Describing people



Rule: in English, adjectives go before the noun and never take a plural -s. *a red apple* → *two red apples* (not *reds*).

size — big / small	They live in a big house with a small garden.
feeling — happy	The children are very happy today.
price — expensive / cheap	This bag is expensive but that one is cheap.
opinion — beautiful	This is a beautiful photo.
difficulty — difficult / easy	Grammar can be difficult, but practice makes it easy.

⚠ COMMON MISTAKES

-  ~~I have three reds apples.~~
-  **I have three red apples.**
-  ~~She is a woman beautiful.~~
-  **She is a beautiful woman.**

More examples

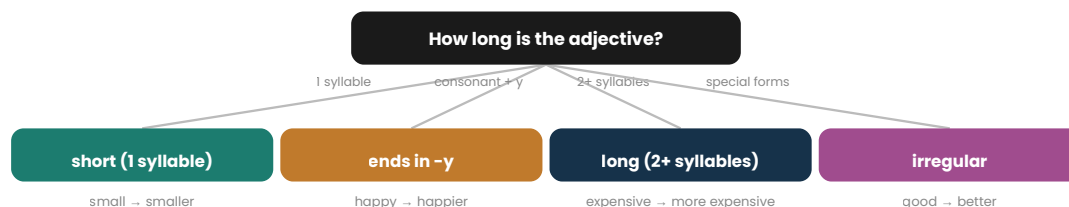
- She has a **new** phone.
- He is a **tall, friendly** man.
- We ate a **delicious** dinner.
- This is an **old** photo.

Comparative Adjectives

Comparing two things



Vocabulary theme for practice: Cities & countries



TYPE	RULE	EXAMPLE
short (1 syllable)	+ er	small → smaller
ends in -e	+ r	nice → nicer
consonant+vowel+consonant	double + er	big → bigger
consonant + y	y → ier	happy → happier
long (2+ syllables)	more + adjective	expensive → more expensive
irregular	special forms	good → better , bad → worse



-ER OR MORE?

Short word (big, small, nice)? Add -er. Long word (expensive, beautiful)? Don't change it — add more before it instead.

⚠ COMMON MISTAKES



~~This car is more fast than mine.~~



This car is faster than mine.



~~She is more tall than me.~~



She is taller than me.



~~Today is more hot than yesterday.~~



Today is hotter than yesterday.

More examples

- She is **taller** than her brother.
- Today is **hotter** than yesterday.



CONNECTS TO WHAT YOU ALREADY KNOW

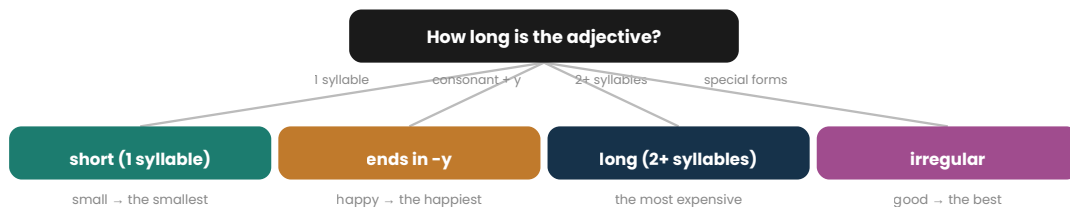
Adjectives (page 27) — these are the same describing words from page 27 — now stretched to compare two things.

Superlative Adjectives

Comparing one thing to all the others



Vocabulary theme for practice: The world around us

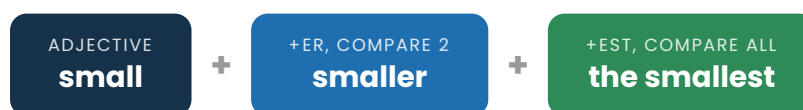


TYPE	RULE	EXAMPLE
short (1 syllable)	the + adj + est	small → the smallest
ends in -e	the + adj + st	nice → the nicest
consonant+vowel+consonant	double + est	big → the biggest
consonant + y	y → iest	happy → the happiest
long (2+ syllables)	the most + adjective	the most expensive
irregular	special forms	the best, the worst



SAME RULE AS COMPARATIVES, PLUS 'THE'

Same rule as comparatives: short word → add -est. Long word → add *the most* before it, unchanged. Always keep *the* in front.



COMMON MISTAKES

- ✗ ~~She is the more intelligent in the class.~~
- ✓ **She is the most intelligent in the class.**
- ✗ ~~This is biggest house on the street.~~
- ✓ **This is the biggest house on the street.**

More examples

- This is **the biggest** city in the country.
- It's **the most beautiful** beach in the region.



CONNECTS TO WHAT YOU ALREADY KNOW

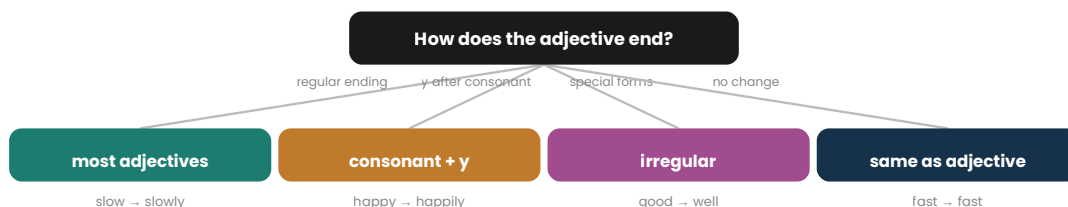
Comparative Adjectives (page 28) — the exact same short/long word rule you just learned — this time comparing against everything, not just one thing.

Adverbs of Manner

How an action happens



Vocabulary theme for practice: Sports



ADJECTIVE	ADVERB	RULE
slow	slowly	most adjectives: + ly
quiet	quietly	+ ly
happy	happily	consonant + y → ily
easy	easily	consonant + y → ily
good	well	irregular
fast / hard / early	fast / hard / early	same form as the adjective

Adjective describes a noun (*a slow driver*). Adverb describes a verb — how the action happens (*She drives slowly*).

⚠ COMMON MISTAKES



~~She sings beautiful.~~



She sings beautifully.



~~He drives very careful.~~



He drives very carefully.



~~She plays tennis good.~~



She plays tennis well.

More examples

- He speaks English **fluently**.
- Please, drive **carefully**.
- They worked **hard** all day.
- He plays football **well**.



CONNECTS TO WHAT YOU ALREADY KNOW

Adjectives (page 27) — most adverbs are just the adjective from page 27 with -ly stuck on the end.

Adverbs of Frequency

How often something happens



Vocabulary theme for practice: Daily habits



FREQ.	WORD	EXAMPLE
~0%	NEVER	I never drink coffee at night.
~10%	RARELY	She rarely eats fast food.
~20%	SELDOM	We seldom watch TV in the morning.
~30%	OCCASIONALLY	They occasionally visit their grandparents.
~50%	SOMETIMES	I sometimes walk to school.
~70%	OFTEN	John often plays football with friends.
~80%	USUALLY	She usually gets up at seven.
~90%	GENERALLY	I generally feel happy in the morning.
~100%	ALWAYS	He always brushes his teeth before bed.

Position: adverbs of frequency go before the main verb (*I often read*) but after the verb to be (*She is always late*). These percentages are approximate — a rough guide to compare the words, not exact maths.

⚠ COMMON MISTAKES

✗ ~~I go often to the cinema.~~

✓ I **often go to the cinema.**

✗ ~~She is late always.~~

✓ She **is always late.**

✗ ~~Always I drink tea.~~

✓ I **always drink tea.**



CONNECTS TO WHAT YOU ALREADY KNOW

Present Simple (page 13) — these words describe habits — exactly what Present Simple is for, so they team up constantly.

Intensifiers

Very, really, quite & too



Vocabulary theme for practice: Food & opinions



strong — VERY

This coffee is **very** hot.

strong, informal — REALLY

I'm **really** tired today.

medium — QUITE

The film was **quite** good.

too much (problem) — TOO

This soup is **too** salty for me.

Very / really make an adjective stronger (no problem). *Too* means more than necessary — it usually shows a problem: *too hot* = we can't drink it yet.

⚠ COMMON MISTAKES



~~This exercise is very difficult for do.~~



This exercise is too difficult to do.



~~I am very much tired.~~



I am very tired.



~~It's too good!~~



It's really good! (too = problem, not just 'very')

More examples

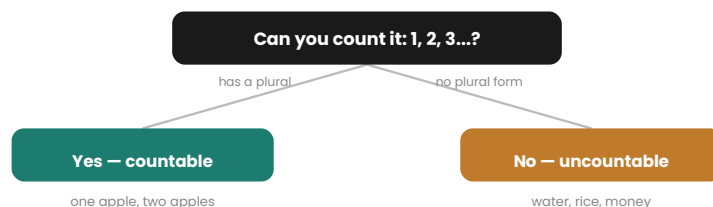
- She is **very** kind.
- He speaks **really** fast.
- It's **quite** cold today.
- This bag is **too** expensive.

Countable & Uncountable Nouns

Things you can count and things you can't



Vocabulary theme for practice: Shopping & food



	COUNTABLE	UNCOUNTABLE
Meaning	You can count them: 1, 2, 3...	You cannot count them separately
Singular / Plural	a book, two books	no plural: water, not waters
Examples	apple, chair, dog, friend, egg	water, milk, rice, money, music, time, information

Tip: uncountable nouns are always singular and never follow a/an or a number. To count them, use a container word: *a glass of water, a piece of information*.

⚠ COMMON MISTAKES



~~I need a money.~~



I need some money.



~~She has three informations.~~



She has some information.



~~How much apples do you have?~~



How many apples do you have?

More examples

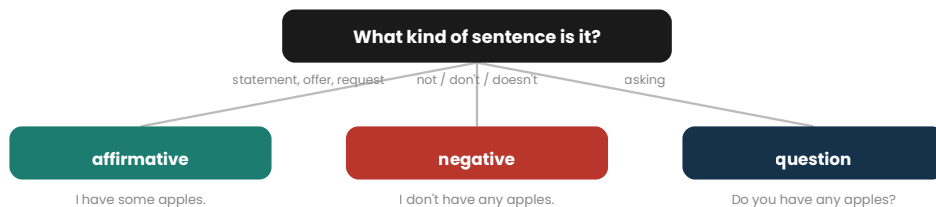
- I have **an** apple. (countable, singular)
- I have three apples. (countable, plural)
- I'd like **some** water. (uncountable, no plural)
- **How much** rice do we need?
- **How many** eggs do we need?

Some / Any / Much / Many

Talking about quantity



Vocabulary theme for practice: Shopping & quantities



Some & any

USE	EXAMPLE
some — affirmative sentences, offers & requests	I have some apples. Would you like some tea?
any — negative sentences	I don't have any apples.
any — questions	Do you have any apples?

Much, many & a lot of

NOUN TYPE	WORD	EXAMPLE
countable (plural)	many / a lot of	How many apples? — I have a lot of apples.
uncountable	much / a lot of	How much water? — I have a lot of water.
small quantity (countable)	a few	I have a few friends here.
small quantity (uncountable)	a little	There is a little milk left.

⚠ COMMON MISTAKES



~~+don't have some money.~~



I **don't have any** money.



~~How much friends do you have?~~



How many friends do you have?



~~There are much people here.~~



There are many people here.



CONNECTS TO WHAT YOU ALREADY KNOW

Countable & Uncountable Nouns (page 33) — whether you use many or much depends entirely on the countable/uncountable split from the last page.

All, Both, Either, Neither, None

Talking about a whole group, or exactly two things

 Vocabulary theme for practice: Choices & groups

				
ALL — every one	BOTH — the two	EITHER — one or the other	NEITHER — not one, not the other	NONE — not a single one

Rule: *all* and *none* talk about a group (3 or more). *Both*, *either*, *neither* only talk about exactly **two** things or people.

WORD	GROUP SIZE	MEANING	EXAMPLE
All	3+	every one, no exceptions	All my friends speak English.
Both	2 (only)	the two together	Both books are mine.
Either	2 (only)	one or the other, your choice	You can take either bus — they both stop here.
Neither	2 (only)	not the one, not the other	Neither answer is correct.
None	3+	not a single one, zero	None of my friends were late.

EITHER / NEITHER + SINGULAR VERB

Either and neither talk about two things, but the verb that follows is singular: *Either day is fine. Neither answer is right.*

CONNECTS TO WHAT YOU ALREADY KNOW

Some / Any / Much / Many (page 34) — all/none are the 'whole group' versions of some/any.

COMMON MISTAKES

-  ~~Both of the book is mine.~~
-  **Both of the books are mine.**
-  ~~Either informations is correct.~~
-  **Either answer is correct.**
-  ~~I don't have none friends.~~
-  **I have none of these friends. / I don't have any friends.**

Prepositions of Place

Where things are



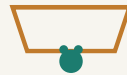
Vocabulary theme for practice: The house



in the basket



on the basket



under the basket



next to the basket



between the baskets



in front of the basket



behind the basket



over the basket

More examples

- The cat is **in** the basket.
- The cat is **on** the basket.
- The cat is **under** the basket.
- The bank is **between** the bakery and the school.
- The dog is **behind** the door.

△ COMMON MISTAKES



~~The cat is in the table.~~



The cat is on the table.



~~She sits between the door.~~



She sits next to the door.



~~The book is in the shelf.~~



The book is on the shelf.

Prepositions of Time

In, on & at



Vocabulary theme for practice: Calendar & appointments

PREPOSITION	USED FOR	EXAMPLE
in	months, years, seasons, parts of the day	in June, in 2026, in summer, in the morning
on	days and dates	on Monday, on 5th July, on my birthday
at	clock times, night, short periods	at 7 o'clock, at night, at the weekend



MEMORY TRICK

Zoom in like a camera: IN the year (wide shot) → ON the day (medium shot) → AT the exact time (close-up).
Bigger period, bigger-feeling word first.



EXCEPTIONS TO REMEMBER

at night (not *in the night*) – the one time expression that breaks the 'in = part of day' rule.
at Christmas / Easter / the weekend – holiday periods use *at*, not *in*.
on time = punctual, exactly when planned. *in time* = before it's too late. Two different meanings!



AT THE WEEKEND, OR ON THE WEEKEND?

UK AU *at the weekend*: See you at the weekend! **US CA** *on the weekend*: See you on the weekend! Both are correct – just pick one and stay consistent.

COMMON MISTAKES



~~I was born on 2001.~~



I was born in 2001.



~~See you in Monday.~~



See you on Monday.



~~The film starts in 8 o'clock.~~



The film starts at 8 o'clock.

More examples

- I was born **in** 2001.
- We go to church **on** Sundays.

Conjunctions

And, but, or, because, so



Vocabulary theme for practice: Opinions & reasons

	FUNCTION	WORD	EXAMPLE
⊕	adding	AND	I have a brother and a sister.
↔	contrast	BUT	She is small but strong.
Y	choice	OR	Do you want tea or coffee?
←	reason	BECAUSE	I'm happy because it's my birthday.
→	result	SO	It was raining, so we stayed home.

Because gives a reason (why?); *so* gives a result (what happened next).

⚠ COMMON MISTAKES



~~I'm tired because I not sleep well.~~



I'm tired because I didn't sleep well.



~~It was cold, because we stayed home.~~



It was cold, so we stayed home.

More examples

- We like pizza **and** pasta.
- He is tired, **but** he is still working.
- You can pay by card **or** in cash.
- I stayed home **because** I was ill.
- She studied hard, **so** she passed the exam.

Question Words

Asking for information



Vocabulary theme for practice: First meeting

	ASKS FOR	WORD	EXAMPLE
	thing	WHAT	What is your name?
	place	WHERE	Where do you live?
	time	WHEN	When is your lesson?
	person	WHO	Who is your teacher?
	reason	WHY	Why are you learning English?
	manner	HOW	How do you go to work?
	quantity, countable	HOW MANY	How many students are there?
	quantity, uncountable	HOW MUCH	How much does it cost?
	age	HOW OLD	How old are you?
	clock time	WHAT TIME	What time is it?

⚠ COMMON MISTAKES



~~What is your name is?~~



What is your name?



~~Where you live?~~



Where do you live?



~~How many money do you have?~~



How much money do you have?

Numbers, Days & Months

Counting & talking about dates



Vocabulary theme for practice: Dates & birthdays

Cardinal numbers

1 one

2 two

3 three

4 four

5 five

6 six

7 seven

8 eight

9 nine

10 ten

11 eleven

12 twelve

13 thirteen

14 fourteen

15 fifteen

16 sixteen

17 seventeen

18 eighteen

19 nineteen

20 twenty

Ordinal numbers

1st first

2nd second

3rd third

4th fourth

5th fifth

6th sixth

7th seventh

8th eighth

9th ninth

10th tenth

Days of the week

Monday · Tuesday · Wednesday · Thursday · Friday · Saturday · Sunday

Months of the year

January · February · March · April · May · June · July · August · September · October · November · December

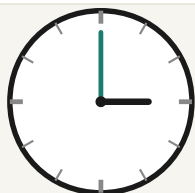
Telling the Time

Clocks, hours & seasons

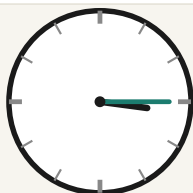


Vocabulary theme for practice: Daily schedule

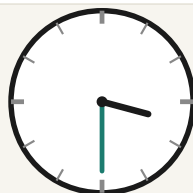
Telling the time



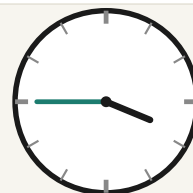
3 o'clock



quarter past 3



half past 3



quarter to 3

Ask: What time is it? / What's the time? **Answer:** It's 3 o'clock. It's half past three. It's quarter to three. Other minutes follow the same pattern: five past three, twenty to three.



WRITING DATES IN NUMBERS

Writing the date 5th July 2026 in numbers: **UK AU** 05/07/2026 (day/month/year) – **US** 07/05/2026 (month/day/year). **CA** both are used. Spelling the month out (5 July / July 5) always avoids confusion.

Seasons

spring · summer · autumn · winter

COMMON MISTAKES



~~It is three and a half.~~



It's half past three.



~~What hour is it?~~



What time is it?

More examples

- The lesson starts at **half past nine**.
- The film ends at **quarter to eleven**.



CONNECTS TO WHAT YOU ALREADY KNOW

Numbers, Days & Months (page 40) – you'll need the numbers from the last page constantly here – 'twenty-five past three' is just numbers in action.

Irregular Verbs (1/2)

Base form → past simple, grouped by pattern



Vocabulary theme for practice: Common actions

These are the most common irregular verbs for A0–A1 level. They do not follow the regular -ed rule, but many follow smaller patterns of their own – grouping them like this makes them easier to remember than one long random list.

Group 1 – No change at all

*read: spelled the same, but pronounced differently – base form sounds like "reed", past form sounds like "red".

BASE	PAST SIMPLE
put	put
cut	cut
hit	hit
let	let
cost	cost
read	read*

Group 2 – Only the vowel changes

BASE	PAST SIMPLE
come	came
give	gave
eat	ate
see	saw
sit	sat
run	ran
swim	swam
drink	drank
begin	began
write	wrote

BASE	PAST SIMPLE
drive	drove
break	broke
speak	spoke
take	took
know	knew
wear	wore
fall	fell
get	got
fly	flew
win	won

Irregular Verbs (2/2)

Base form → past simple, grouped by pattern



Vocabulary theme for practice: Common actions

Group 3 — Add -t or -d

BASE	PAST SIMPLE
have	had
make	made
say	said
tell	told
find	found
buy	bought
bring	brought
teach	taught
think	thought
sleep	slept
feel	felt
meet	met
pay	paid
sell	sold
send	sent
lose	lost
leave	left
hear	heard
build	built
spend	spent

Group 4 — The most irregular of all

BASE	PAST SIMPLE
be	was/were
go	went
do	did

English Around the World (1/2)

Grammar: British, American, Canadian & Australian



Vocabulary theme for practice: Travel & culture

English differs slightly by country, but everyone understands each other. Here are the differences that matter most for a beginner.

Grammar differences

POINT	WHAT CHANGES	EXAMPLE
Possession	UK AU have got US CA have / have got	I've got a car. = I have a car.
Groups of people	UK AU singular or plural verb US CA singular only	My team is/are winning.
Weekend	UK AU at the weekend US CA on the weekend	See you at/on the weekend!
Offers	UK Shall we...? US CA AU Should we...?	Shall we go? (UK) · Should we go? (US)
Past tense spelling	UK AU CA learnt, dreamt US learned, dreamed	I learnt / learned French.
Dates in numbers	UK AU day/month/year US month/day/year	5/7/2026 = 5 July (UK) or May 7 (US)

These badges appear throughout the manual wherever one of these points comes up — flip back to see them in context (Have Got, Will, Prepositions of Time, Past Simple, Numbers pages).

English Around the World (2/2)

Spelling & everyday vocabulary



Vocabulary theme for practice: Everyday vocabulary

Spelling patterns

PATTERN	UK/AU/CA	US
-our / -or	colour, favourite	color, favorite
-re / -er	centre, theatre	center, theater
-ise / -ize	realise, organise	realize, organize
-lling / -ling	travelling, cancelled	traveling, canceled

A few everyday words that differ

UK	US
flat	apartment
holiday	vacation
autumn	fall
trousers	pants
biscuit	cookie
rubbish	garbage
football	soccer
lift	elevator

Good news: grammar structures elsewhere in this manual work the same way in every variety of English — only these small points change, and native speakers understand all of them.